

Sales Trader Commentary: Green Light for Risk-On with Potential Speed Bumps Ahead | GSTW

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What a week for TAIEX+4% last week! Can you imagine we are around 5% from all-time high? We are at the end of 2Q26 earnings, and a lot of investors are taking a breather at the moment. Check out my pulse check below:

Investor Feedback & Key Observations

- **Position Update:** Foreigners bought US\$5.1bn in cash equities last week, mainly in Other Tech (+US\$3.7bn), alongside TSMC and Industrials (+US\$0.5bn each). Two way flows from domestic investors without a clear direction. The ongoing inflows were also supported by stronger TWD; we saw 0.6% jump on 8/17/2026 to close below 32 handle, biggest single day rally in over a year. *For more color on equity-related FX thoughts on NTD, check out this note [here](#).*
 - Desk was very active and saw inflows from all types of clients. We saw ongoing interest in momentum sectors and higher risk appetite (i.e. more long short activity), though overall market turnover was down comparing to peak time like May and June this year.
- **Are We Back to Risk On? Short answer: yes, I think we are!** But some questions to consider: 1) how far further can the index climb without taking a breather? 2) how big of the profit taking is it going to be this time? and 3) where is the remaining dry powder?
 - **My view:** a healthy consolidation on the index is definitely reasonable with out a July-style unwind. On the other hand, from a liquidity and position perspective, I believe there is more fuel to drive the index given level we still have ~14% room to grow before we refresh margin loan balance record. In addition, based on GS preliminary EPFR data (~20% of total AUM reported), Asian funds are most most UW Taiwan in July, again more room to add back position.
- **Momentum Sector Trade Saw Divergent Performance:**
 - ABF/CCL were the crowded long theme for both foreigners and domestic investors (note that foreigners net bought over US\$700mn in Unimicron on 8/17/2026, the most since the stock listed) given they have the most structural and imminent fundamental upside. Most of these ABF/CCL stocks are (almost) back to all-time-high and recover their Jul'26 sell-off.
 - CPO gained strong momentum in the past 2 weeks coming from low base and rallied along with US peers. +VE sentiment from headline such as Nvidia's SpectrumX and price hike in InP substrate.
 - MLCC did not receive much love and underperformed significantly vs other themes. Thinking on the bright side, perhaps MLCC sector may offer a relatively better risk-reward return coming from a relative low base?

- **2Q26 Earnings Recap:** Taiwan companies have reported 2Q26 earnings, growing +132%/+31% yoy/qoq so far, with 48% beats versus 38% misses, and a median earnings/sales surprise of +14%/+4%. For the past week, earnings were the main catalyst to drive stock movement, especially pre-position ahead of the earnings call/analyst meeting. Both Beat and Miss saw meaningful sell-on-facts afterwards, indicating that expectations are often priced in. Check below exhibit for earnings summary.
- **MSCI Rebalance Coming Up.** MSCI has announced their quarterly review with changes effective on **8/31/2026**. Taiwan's weight in MSCI EM will increase by 14bp to 27.6%. We estimate US\$6.2bn of gross two-way passive flows and US\$1.2bn net passive inflows. See below for our pro forma flow estimate.
- **What Else in August?** market has digested the macro events such as NFP and CPI well this month. Local futures are expiring this week, with Jackson Holes Symposium and Nvidia earnings coming up at the end of the month.

AEJ funds (US\$95 bn - Active Fund Only)				
Market	OW/UW allocation (in bp)	Market	1-mth chg	3-mth chg
China	300	Korea	100	(15)
Singapore	160	Indonesia	60	55
Indonesia	145	Thailand	10	(5)
Hong Kong	125	Singapore	5	(35)
Thailand	60	India	5	85
Philippines	10	Malaysia	2	20
Malaysia	-45	Philippines	(1)	5
Korea	-110	China	(2)	110
India	-270	Hong Kong	(30)	(75)
Taiwan	-580	Taiwan	(145)	(150)

Note: The allocation of AEJ mandate only includes active funds, as of Jul '26

Exhibit 1. AEJ Fund Allocation Jul'26 Edition

(All Reported Companies)				(Ex-Financials)				(Ex-Financials)				(All Companies)			
Taiwan Sectors (TWSE + TPEX)		Reported		Net Income Growth (%)		6M2026 (as % of FY est.)		Sales Growth (%)		Net Margin Chg (p.p.)		2Q26 Surprise (vs. Cons) (%)		EPS Revision	
		# cos	% cap	2Q2026	1H2026	yoy	qoq	2Q2026	1H2026	2Q2026	1H2026	Median	Earnings Wgt	2026E EPS	2027E EPS
				yoy	qoq	yoy	hoh	yoy	qoq	yoy	hoh	Net Inc	Sales	Net Inc	Sales
Semiconductors	212	97%	113%	30%	91%	47%	50%	38%	15%	33%	20%	14.1	4.5	11.5	7.0
Tech Hardware	355	92%	127%	41%	72%	27%	45%	47%	18%	43%	16%	1.5	0.7	0.7	0.4
Software & Services	35	67%	89%	31%	64%	(1%)	44%	19%	8%	18%	3%	2.6	1.1	1.8	(0.2)
Banks	12	76%	60%	4%	71%	27%	55%	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Insurance & DivFins	16	19%	99%	91%	99%	46%	58%	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Real Estate	51	85%	86%	20%	114%	(12%)	27%	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Commodities	129	91%	548%	69%	99%	323%	77%	13%	12%	5%	11%	13.2	3.5	9.2	6.8
Capital Goods	235	84%	205%	41%	133%	36%	52%	18%	15%	15%	5%	7.2	2.2	5.4	2.4
Transportation	26	94%	58%	20%	(4%)	(8%)	52%	21%	16%	7%	10%	2.7	0.3	(1.4)	(2.4)
Consumer Discret.	213	88%	161%	17%	63%	(9%)	42%	7%	6%	3%	2%	3.8	0.6	2.3	(0.8)
Consumer Staples	47	95%	18%	9%	13%	9%	55%	4%	1%	4%	2%	0.5	0.3	0.3	0.3
Commun. Services	24	89%	14%	5%	11%	12%	53%	7%	1%	7%	(3%)	0.8	0.6	0.5	1.7
Health Care	94	75%	(301%)	(133%)	(35%)	(75%)	42%	18%	11%	16%	8%	(6.3)	(17.0)	(3.6)	(15.6)
Utilities	11	79%	(23%)	(22%)	26%	100%	13%	133%	32%	124%	94%	(11.2)	(3.7)	(5.7)	0.1
MSCI Taiwan	65	95%	89%	28%	70%	34%	51%	40%	15%	37%	13%	3.6	1.6	2.3	2.1
All Taiwan	1461	91%	132%	31%	91%	38%	50%	36%	15%	31%	14%	4.8	1.5	3.3	2.0

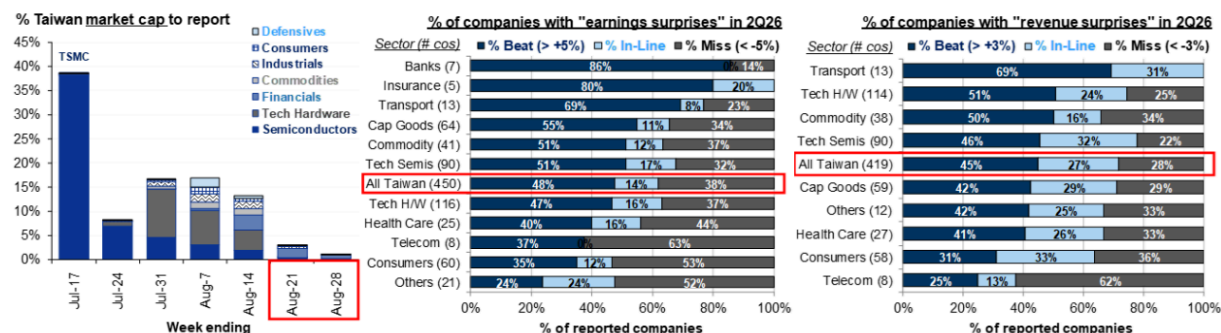


Exhibit 2. 2Q26 Taiwan Earnings Recap

MSCI Taiwan						
	Standard (Large+Mid Cap)			IMI (Large+Mid+Small)		
	Current	Proforma	Change	Current	Proforma	Change
Index Cap (US\$bn)	3,312	3,339	+1%	3,769	3,784	+0%
3M ADVT (US\$bn)	17	19	+11%	28	29	+2%
# of constituents	77	74	-3	372	360	-12
- added / deleted		3 / 6			9 / 21	
- high/lower FIF		2 / 1			27 / 31	
	Current weight (%)	Proforma weight (%)	Change (bps)	Gross Passive Buying (US\$m)	Gross Passive Selling (US\$m)	Net Passive Flows (US\$m)
Asia	18.7%	18.9%	14	207	(132)	75
EM	27.4%	27.6%	14	2,412	(1,681)	730
Global (ACWI)	3.15%	3.17%	3	746	(309)	437
Note: Pricing as of Aug 12, 2026	Aggregate			3,676	(2,491)	1,185

Exhibit 3.MSCI Taiwan Flow Estimate

	Taiwan			All Country World		
MSCI Taiwan	Weight (%)			Passive Flows (US\$m)		
GICS Sector / Industry	Current	Change (bps)	Change (pips)	Gross Buying	Gross Selling	Net Flows
Tech Hardware & Semis	87.4%	+65	+227	3,334	(1,063)	2,271
Capital Goods	0.7%	-1	+0	42	(36)	6
Utilities	0.0%	+0	+0	2	-	2
Energy	0.0%	+0	+0	-	-	-
Metals & Mining	0.2%	-0	+0	0	(5)	(4)
Telecommunication Services	0.8%	-1	+0	1	(6)	(5)
Real Estate	0.0%	+0	+0	0	(8)	(7)
Autos & Components	0.0%	+0	+0	0	(7)	(7)
Software & Services	0.0%	+0	+0	0	(8)	(8)
Consumer Staples	0.5%	-0	+0	2	(10)	(8)
Consumer Retail & Services	0.1%	-0	+0	4	(14)	(10)
Insurance & Other Financials	3.2%	-5	-3	7	(80)	(72)
Health Care	0.5%	-7	-10	124	(208)	(84)
Banks	4.6%	-11	-11	127	(250)	(124)
Transportation	0.5%	-9	-13	9	(173)	(164)
Internet/Media & Entertainment	0.2%	-16	-26	11	(311)	(300)
Chemicals & Other Materials	1.4%	-16	-23	12	(313)	(300)

Exhibit 4. MSCI Weight Estimate by Sectors

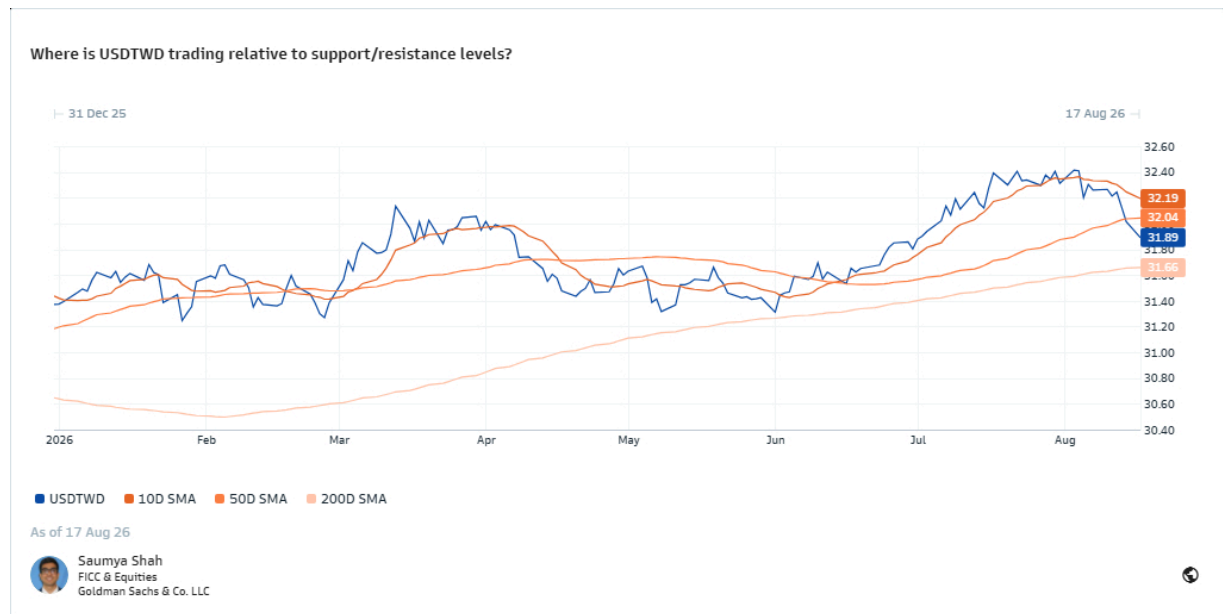


Exhibit 5. USDTWD YTD Historical Data

Please feel free to reach out to your GS representative to discuss any ideas.

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Source for all: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Company Data, Bloomberg as of 8/18/2026

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